Your MIS 430 Group Project

Closing the gap between a resource and the student who needs it

UA MIS

Systems Analysis & Design · MIS 430

What's going on in MIS?

Events, announcements, and anything you want to share

STUDENT SPOTLIGHT

About Me

Today's presentations

YOUR GROUP PROJECT: THE PROBLEM

The resource is there, but the student who needs it never reaches it.

UA offers far more than most students realize. They miss out anyway.

Why students miss out

- They don't know a resource exists.
- Or maybe they know it exists, but they can't figure out how to access it.
- Or they tried to use it once, but it goes confusing, so they gave up.

YOUR JOB

Find one specific instance of this gap, and close it.

Design a solution that helps the right students find and reach the right resource at the right time.

What we're telling you

- The problem is resource discovery and/or access.
- Your solution should include planned AI functionality.
- You produce an interactive mockup plus the necessary documentation behind it.

What we're NOT telling you

- Which resource you focus on.
- Which students are missing it, and why.
- Why the gap actually exists (awareness? a confusing path? stigma, cost, a bad first try?).
- Whether the problem people first name is the real one.

THE BIG FOCUS

Why does the gap exist? You can’t build the right tool without first identifying the reason behind the gap.

A tool that fixes an awareness problem looks nothing like one that fixes a confusing process.

“Students can't find resources” is not something you can build for

Which resource? Which students? Freshmen who don't know the vocabulary? Transfer students who arrived after orientation? Students who'd never think to ask?

The gap is different for different people. You won't know whose gap you're closing until you go find out.

Where AI fits

Matching the right student to the right resource at the right moment is a great problem for AI.

It's also where AI can cause real harm: recommending the wrong resource to a student in distress, revealing that someone sought a sensitive service, or confidently sending someone down the wrong path.

Part of your job is deciding where the AI needs guardrails, what it should refuse to do, and when a human must be involved.

A NOTE ON SENSITIVE RESOURCES

Counseling, health, Title IX, accommodations, hardship support.

You're welcome to build for these, and the gaps there are obviously important. But do so with the knowledge that the bar for your harm and guardrail analysis is higher, because the stakes are higher with this type of information.

YOU CAN'T DEFINE THIS ALONE

Go interview real potential users.

If you only talk to people who think just like you and have the exact same experiences as you, the interviews won't be very helpful.

Before you lock your problem

These interviews you conduct are the foundation of everything you build. Talk to a wide variety of students about where their resource gaps live.

You'll submit an Elicitation Report documenting what you learned before you lock your problem definition.

What you'll do throughout the group project

Define & plan

SOW · Process models · Data model · Product backlog & first sprint

Make it safe & real

Harm & guardrail analysis · User testing plan & results · Change management plan

The record & the product

BMAD decision log · Interactive mockup · Final presentation

Most of this accumulates gradually and is tracked in your weekly status reports. Full detail is in your project information document.

YOUR FINAL PRESENTATION

You present your solution to the class, and both content & delivery are graded.

How clearly you tell the story of the problem, how well you make the case, how you present as a team. Treat it as a real professional presentation.

A note on final project grading

- GROUP participation is required
- Deliverables and presentations will be rank-ordered
- Please don’t let yourself be surprised by your grade

What happens next

- You’ll meet your teams (and I suggest making a **team contract**).
- You'll start fieldwork: interviewing real students about resource gaps.
- You'll meet BMAD, the AI tool you'll use through the build. (More on that next week)
- Weekly status reports keep your team on track.

Before you go

- Upcoming assignments & due dates
- Course calendar
- Attendance quiz